GEO + SEO Report — United Methodist Church of Minot

Site: https://umc-minot-maine.netlify.app (confirmed live) **Date:** 2026-07-26 **Scope:** GEO (AI-search visibility) + traditional SEO for the static Netlify site

---

✅ COMPLETED (applied, pushed, and verified live)

🚨 Root-cause fix — why nothing was deploying

- [x] **Removed uninstalled Netlify build plugins** (`@netlify/plugin-sitemap` , `netlify-plugin-lighthouse`). They were declared in `netlify.toml` but never installed, so **every Netlify build failed** ("Plugins must be installed…") and the live site was frozen on an old deploy — no change could go live. Removing them fixed the pipeline; the site now builds and deploys on every push to `main` . **All fixes below are now live** at https://umc-minot-maine.netlify.app.

Critical fixes — were actively hurting the site

- [x] **Broken carousel + footer images fixed** across all 4 pages. References used wrong capitalization (`IMG_0469.jpeg` , `Screenshot…PM.png`) and 404'd on Netlify's case-sensitive hosting. Now match the real lowercase filenames.
- [x] **Broken social-preview image fixed** — `og:image` pointed to a nonexistent `church-hero.jpg` ; now uses the real `minot+umc.jpg` .
- [x] **Domain standardized to `umc-minot-maine.netlify.app`** (the actual live URL) across canonical tags, Open Graph, sitemap, and robots.txt. Removed the earlier cross-domain redirects that pointed at an unconfigured custom domain (would have broken the site).
- [x] **Broken asset references fixed** — footer logo (hidden U+202F space in filename) renamed to `footer-logo.png` ; dead `favicon.ico` links removed (SVG favicon remains).
- [x] **Schema data errors corrected** — `email` was literally `"PENDING"` ; `foundingDate` was `1870` (contradicting the site's own 1835 history); event date was a stale 2024.
- [x] **Invalid `netlify.toml` fixed** — had a duplicate `[build]` table that can break deploys; merged into one.

GEO (AI-search) additions

- [x] **FAQ section + FAQPage schema** — 5 answer-shaped Q&As (service time, location, who's welcome, what to expect, history) that ChatGPT / Google AI Overviews / voice assistants can quote directly. Added a "FAQ" nav link and matching CSS.
- [x] **`llms.txt` created** — AI-crawler guide with clean key facts.
- [x] **`robots.txt` welcomes AI crawlers** — GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, OAI-SearchBot, Google-Extended, Applebot-Extended, etc.
- [x] **Enriched Church schema** — added geo coordinates, openingHoursSpecification, areaServed (Minot/Auburn/Mechanic Falls/Poland), accessibility features, isAccessibleForFree, logo/image, free-offer pricing.

Traditional SEO

- [x] **Canonical + Open Graph tags added to 3 subpages** (calendar, bible-study, pastoral-care) — they previously had none.
- [x] **Sitemap rebuilt** with real page URLs (was anchor fragments), current dates.
- [x] **Geo meta tags** (geo.region, geo.position, ICBM) + font preconnect + `loading="lazy"` on images.
- [x] **Placeholder social links removed** from footer + schema (no real profiles yet).

Validation: Both JSON-LD blocks parse valid; no broken image references remain.

⬜ REMAINING — prioritized, chip away top to bottom

🥇 Priority 1 — Off-site (biggest discovery impact, do these first)

- [ ] **Claim/verify Google Business Profile** for the church. *Why:* #1 driver of "church near me" + Google Maps discovery for a local church. *Effort:* ~30 min. https://business.google.com — search the address, claim it, add hours (Sun 10:00–11:15), photos, phone, and the umc-minot-maine.netlify.app link.
- [ ] **Set up Google Search Console** and verify `umc-minot-maine.netlify.app`. *Then:* submit `https://umc-minot-maine.netlify.app/sitemap.xml` and use "Request Indexing" on the homepage. *Why:* turns passive/slow discovery into days, and shows what queries you appear for. https://search.google.com/search-console
- [ ] **Set up Bing Webmaster Tools** (feeds ChatGPT + Copilot search). Can import directly from Google Search Console. https://www.bing.com/webmasters

🥈 Priority 2 — Verify my automated changes render correctly

- [x] **Deployed and verified live** — build now succeeds; canonical, FAQ section, fixed footer logo, corrected image paths, `llms.txt`, and PWA icons all confirmed serving correctly on umc-minot-maine.netlify.app.
- [x] **Exact map coordinates applied** — `44.0851445, -70.3191671` set in the two `geo.position` / `ICBM` meta tags and the JSON-LD `geo` block in `index.html`.
- [ ] **Test the structured data** at https://search.google.com/test/rich-results — paste the live umc-minot-maine.netlify.app URL; should show Church + FAQ with no errors.
- [ ] **Test the social preview** at https://www.opengraph.xyz — confirm the image shows.

🥉 Priority 3 — Content & authority (steady, ongoing)

- [ ] **Get listed in the Maine UMC conference / New England Conference church directory** with a link to umc-minot-maine.netlify.app. *Why:* a trusted, topical backlink — strong AI + SEO signal.
- [ ] **Community listings:** town of Minot site, local Facebook community groups, church-finder sites (e.g., UMC.org "Find-A-Church", church directories). Keep the name, address, phone **identical** everywhere (NAP consistency).
- [ ] **Add real social profiles when they exist** — then I'll re-add them to the footer and the schema `sameAs` (accurate links boost AI entity recognition).
- [ ] **Publish a little fresh content periodically** (a sermon post, event recap, or seasonal note). Even monthly signals the site is active and gives AI more to cite.

🔧 Priority 4 — Optional technical polish

- [x] **CSP fix for embeds applied** — added `frame-src https://padlet.com https://calendar.google.com;` (and `https:` to `img-src`) in `netlify.toml` so the Padlet prayer wall and Google Calendar iframes render. *Verify on the live site after deploy.*
- [x] **PWA icons + screenshots generated** — `icon-192.png`, `icon-512.png`, `screenshot-desktop.png`, `screenshot-mobile.png` created and added to `images/` (were declared in `manifest.json` but missing). Enables "install app" and clears console errors.
- [ ] **Fix the soft-404 catch-all** — `_redirects` / `netlify.toml` has `/* → /index.html 200`, so every missing/typo'd URL returns the homepage with HTTP 200 instead of a real 404. Bad for SEO (search engines see infinite duplicate "pages"). For a static multi-page site, replace with a real 404 page (`/* /404.html 404`). *Ask me to apply this.*
- [ ] **Compress large images** — `images/img_0469.jpeg` is ~5.3 MB (way too big for web); others are large too. Resize to ~1600px wide and re-save at ~80% quality to cut page weight dramatically and improve Core Web Vitals. *Ask me and I'll batch-optimize them.*
- [ ] **Fix dead in-page links** — a few "Learn More" / "Listen Now" buttons on the homepage point to `href="#"` (Small Groups, Online Sermons). Point them at real destinations or remove.
- [ ] `#serve` **nav link** points to a section that doesn't exist on the page. Either add a Serve section or remove the link from nav/footer.

Quick reference — what changed, by file

File	Change
`index.html`	OG image, geo meta, preconnect, image case fixes, enriched Church schema, new FAQ schema + section, removed social links
`calendar.html` / `bible-study.html` / `pastoral-care.html`	Canonical + OG tags, footer logo image fix
`sitemap.xml`	Real page URLs, umc-minot-maine.netlify.app, current dates
`robots.txt`	umc-minot-maine.netlify.app, explicit AI-crawler allows
`llms.txt`	**New file** — AI content guide
`netlify.toml`	**Removed uninstalled build plugins (fixed failing deploys)**, duplicate `[build]` table fix, CSP `frame-src` for embeds, removed dead cross-domain redirects
`_redirects`	Removed dead cross-domain redirects (kept clean-URL + SPA rules)
`styles.css`	FAQ section styling appended